Next came the question of a tiara. My aunts asked if Meg would like to wear my mother's. We were both touched. Meg then spent hours and hours with her dress designer, getting the veil to match the tiara, giving it a similar scalloped edge.

Shortly before the wedding, however, Granny reached out. She offered us access to *her* collection of tiaras. She even invited us to Buckingham Palace to try them on. *Do come over*, I remember her saying.

Extraordinary morning. We walked into Granny's private dressing room, right next to her bedroom, a space I'd never been in. Along with Granny was a jewelry expert, an eminent historian who knew the lineage of each stone in the royal collection. Also present was Granny's dresser and confidante, Angela. Five tiaras were arrayed on a table, and Granny directed Meg to try on each one before a full-length mirror. I stood behind, watching.

One was all emeralds. One was aquamarines. Each was more dazzlingly stunning than the last. Each took my breath.

I wasn't the only one. Granny said to Meg quite tenderly: *Tiaras suit you.*

Meg melted. *Thank you, Ma'am.*

One of the five, however, stood out. Everyone agreed. It was beautiful, seemingly made for Meg. Granny said it would be placed in a safe directly and she looked forward to seeing it on Meg's head come the Big Day.

Make sure, she added, *that you practice putting it on. With your hairdresser. It's tricky and you don't want to be doing it for the first time on the wedding day.*

We left the Palace feeling awed and loved and grateful.

A week later we contacted Angela and asked her to please send us the chosen tiara so we could practice putting it on. We'd done research, and we'd spoken to Kate about her own experience, and we'd learned that Granny's warning was spot on. The placing of the tiara was an intricate, elaborate process. It had to be first sewn to the veil, then Meg's hairdresser would need to fix it to a small plait in her hair. Complicated, time-consuming—we'd need at least one dress rehearsal.

For some reason, however, Angela didn't respond to any of our messages.

We kept trying.

No response.